

LEARN, GROW, SHARE

The technology behemoth promotes a culture where employees are free to be curious, to experiment and to share the things they learn

By Nidhi Singal

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► **GENIUS, GOES AN** old saying, is 99 per cent perspiration and 1 per cent inspiration. Taking the analogy forward, one could possibly say the same thing about the potential of a person—work hard to learn new things and grow. Microsoft certainly believes in something similar, and calls it the ‘growth mindset’. The potential of an employee isn’t pre-determined—the person can learn and grow, the company says. “Part of the mindset needed for this is accepting what we don’t know and being willing to learn and take action to drive meaningful change,” says Ira Gupta, Head of Human Resources, Microsoft India.

The firm promotes a culture where employees are free to be curious, to experiment and to share the things they learn. No wonder that ‘Growth and Learning Opportunities’ is one of the top attributes for Microsoft India in the BT-Taggd Best Companies to Work For in India ranking.

This growth mindset, however, requires constant support, guidance, empathy and resilience from leadership and Microsoft—which has some 18,000 employees in India—has a plan in place. Under its Model-Coach-Care framework, the company trains its leaders and managers to lead through empowerment and accountability. Managers proactively coach team members for success across boundaries and help the team respond to the changing environment and be more thoughtful about understanding individual capabilities and unique circumstances to help them navigate opportunities and challenges. For instance, through its Employee Resource Groups, Microsoft builds a diverse and empowered workforce. Led by Microsoft India leaders, each group taps into a workplace subject and comes together as a self-managed team to drive inclusion around that aspect in the company. “When we think about leadership at Microsoft, a few years ago we identified a set of actionable principles personal to Microsoft, aligned with our mission, ambitions and culture. These are our



A GROWTH MINDSET Ira Gupta, Head of Human Resources, Microsoft India

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MICROSOFT INDIA

Top attributes

- Growth and learning opportunities
- Flexibility at work
- Focus on well-being